

SOFTWARE DESIGN 2

GROUP 32 AUTOVAULT USER GUIDE

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AutoVault: User Guide

AutoVault is a backup tool that copies chosen folders on a schedule, keeps a history of versions, and lets you restore an earlier version.

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What AutoVault Does

- Copies a folder (source) to a backup folder as a new version for each backup.
- Backs up only when there is something to back up – when a file has been modified, added or deleted.
- Ignores files that have certain extensions, such as .tmp or .log.
- Stores the 5 newest versions of each job and removes other ones.
- Allows restoring a chosen version to a chosen folder.
- Can perform automatic backups at regular intervals when the software is working.
- Automatically saves your jobs and writes a history log.

What you need

- A computer with Java installed. AutoVault was built and tested with Java 21.
- The AutoVault project (NetBeans project AutoV), or the packaged file dist/AutoV.jar.

Launching AutoVault

In NetBeans: open the AutoV project, set ui.Main as main class and press F6. The AutoVault window opens. ui.Main only starts the window; the console menu (ui.CliMenu) is not opened automatically.

Working with the window

The window presents a table of your jobs with columns Name, Source, Destination, Every (minutes), Last run and Versions. It updates every 5 seconds.

Button	What it does
Add job	Opens a form. Fill in the name, the source folder, the backup folder, how often (in minutes), and the extensions to skip (separated by commas, for example tmp,log). Use Browse... to pick folders.
Backup now	Backs up the job you selected in the table
Versions / Restore	Lists the versions of the selected job. Choose one, then

	choose the folder to restore into
Remove job	Removes the selected job after you confirm. The backup files already made are kept
QA / Logging	Opens a new window where you can view activity logs, run quality assurance tests, and export the log file.
Save	Saves your jobs now

The line at the bottom of the screen will show you what was done, such as "Backup finished successfully" or "There were no changes since the last backup, there is nothing to do." You exit the program by closing the window.

How Backup is Done

1.Initial backup: All files in the source folder are copied to a new version folder in the backup folder.
2.Following backups: AutoVault checks for changes first; if there were none, it outputs "No changes ... Nothing to do" and does not make a new version; otherwise, it creates a new version if a file is modified, added, or deleted.
3.A version is a complete copy of the source folder that can be restored individually.
4.Skipped extensions are never copied and changes to these files do not create a new backup.
5.Retention: Only the five newest versions of a job are retained. On making the sixth one, the oldest version is deleted from the disk.
6.Automatic backups: They occur according to the interval you specify (at least 1 minute). The first automatic backup occurs one interval after the initial setup.

Restoring a version

1. Choose the job, then the version you want.
2. Choose the folder to restore into. **A new, empty folder is safest.** Files with the same names in that folder are overwritten.
3. Open that folder to see the files as they were at that version.

Where AutoVault keeps its files

File or folder	What it holds
jobs.dat	Your saved jobs and their version lists. Delete it to start with no jobs
AutoVault.log	The activity log: jobs added, backups, restores, retention, and

	errors
Backup folder	One sub-folder per version, named `ver` followed by a number. Version names shown in the menu look like `20261031_184123_612` (date and time)

These files are made in the folder AutoVault runs from.

Messages you may see

Message	Meaning and what to do
No changes ... Nothing to do.	Nothing in the source folder has changed since the last backup. This is normal
That source folder does not exist.	The path you typed is wrong. Check the spelling, or use **Browse...** in the window
Backup folder cannot be inside the source folder.	Choose a backup folder that is outside the source folder
The interval must be a whole number. / Interval must be at least 1 minute.	Type a number of 1 or more
Backup failed for job ...	The backup could not run, for example because the source folder was deleted. Check the folder and try again
Version not found / Job not found	The version or job no longer exists. List them again and pick from the list
Please type a number from 1 to N.	Pick one of the numbers shown

Tips and limits

- Because each version is a full copy, backups use disk space. The limit of 5 versions keeps this under control.
- Automatic backups only run while AutoVault is open.
- Restore into a new folder first, and check the files before replacing anything important.
- To see what AutoVault did, open `AutoVault.log` in a text editor.